

face recognition and iris readers are being introduced in access control systems for promptness, non-intrusiveness and accuracy of identification. Those players who sense these developments and adopt will get the early-mover's advantage. Also, players having their own development centres definitely have an edge over other players in terms of introducing new technology and applications faster in security products domain.

How are security systems integrating with telecom?

Communication is the backbone of any organisation and securing an organisation's assets is vital in today's scenario. Being a manufacturer of telecom and security products, Matrix has an added advantage to fulfill customer requirements of integrating telecom and security products.

By integrating access control and video surveillance system with PBX and gateways, customer can use various advanced features like call-forward on other extensions, door lock/unlock from extensions, security alerts on mobile, live monitoring on mobile, etc.

What are the resulting implications?

Nowadays customers are looking for solutions which can integrate both telecom and security products. A normal mobile phone is used to control several devices at home and office, and also as an alarming device in case of security breach. Also, the need of such telecom devices and applications is increasing. As a result of the increased need of such technology and applications, both telecom and security industry veterans are coming together to offer converged solutions to their customers.

The convergence of telecom and security has positive implications on all the participants of the value chain—from technology developers, manufacturers and associated product designers to even end-users.

You have an R&D centre in India. Tell us more about it.

Matrix Comsec is a versatile designer and manufacturer of telecom and security products, which are marketed in more than 50 countries. We design and develop all our products in our dedicated R&D centre, which is one of the biggest in India in our respective domain.

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Matrix engages more than 200 engineers for its R&D activities like software and hardware designing, engineering, quality analysis and more. Our R&D centre is approved by the Department of Scientific and Industrial

Research, government of India.

What's its R&D focus?

The Matrix R&D is focused on strengthening the existing product portfolio. We are developing new products which can cater to varied applications to meet customers' specific needs. Currently, we are working on converged solution in telecom. Besides this we are working on next-generation user terminals and enterprise gateway devices to strengthen our existing telecom product line.

On the security side, we are developing video surveillance systems after the launch of access control, time attendance and fire-alarm systems in quick succession.

What advantages does India offer for R&D, in comparison to other countries?

The Indian electronics sector has achieved a phenomenal growth during the last few years and is poised to take a big leap with the rising investment in R&D. India has a growing talent pool capable of handling high-end knowledge-based work and research. The country offers new opportunities to budding engineers in different verticals. India also enjoys the advantage of low cost. More and more companies are turning to India for off-shoring work, as quality work can be done at cheaper rates here.

What are the areas of R&D that India needs to further work upon?

India has largely been a follower in terms of technology development. We need to think beyond replicating technology products, and understand the importance of R&D in terms of intellectual resources and investment.

For electronics and telecom manufacturing industry, the IP policies and regulations in place were not so encouraging as in pharmaceutical and IT industry. Many entrepreneurs have faced problems in developing new technologies due to unfriendly IP policies and their R&D initiatives have converted into an expense rather than investment. ●



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